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Kaohsiung International Airport

The southern Taiwan gateway's history from a 1944 airfield to today's international terminal, with the runway dimension and MRT connection the operator states directly.

KAOHSIUNG INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT			
CAA TAKEOVER, FORMING KAOHSIUNG AVIATION STATION 1965-07-01 ^[1]	INTERNATIONAL PASSENGER SERVICE OPENED 1972-10, first route Kaohsiung-Hong Kong operated by China Airlines ^[1]	NEW INTERNATIONAL TERMINAL OPENED 1997-01-11 ^[1]	KAOHSIUNG MRT RED LINE CONNECTION 2008 ^[1]

Kaohsiung International Airport traces to a 1944 airfield, 小港飛行場, at the site.^[1] The Civil Aeronautics Administration took it over on 1 July 1965, forming 高雄航空站 (Kaohsiung Aviation Station), initially served by China Airlines, Far Eastern Air Transport and Civil Air Transport.^[1] It was upgraded to international-station status in 1969.^[1] International passenger service began in October 1972, when China Airlines opened a Kaohsiung-Hong Kong route — the station's own history page records this as "開放國際客運業務，華航首航「高雄—香港」航線."^[1]

A new international terminal opened on 11 January 1997.^[1] The Kaohsiung MRT's Red Line reached the airport in 2008, giving the station a rail connection into the city.^[1] CAA's own airport-distribution page lists Kaohsiung International Airport among the 17 airports under its administration.^[3]

The operator's own facility page states the runway as 3,150 by 60 metres.^[2]

A classification CAA states, not infers

CAA's own airport-distribution page marks several of the airports it administers as 軍民合用 — joint military-civil use — including both Taipei `[/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/]` Songshan `[/rail/met ro/stations/g19/]` and Taichung `[/rail/thsr/stations/taichung/]`.^[3] Kaohsiung International Airport is not marked that way on the same list; CAA lists it simply as 高雄國際機場, with no joint-use annotation attached.^[3] This page reports that distinction as it appears on the primary source rather than assuming a military role for Kaohsiung on the general reputation the airport has in secondary coverage — CAA's own list is the more specific evidence, and it draws the line differently than reputation might suggest.

What remains TBC

A current annual passenger count, a current domestic or international route network, and a construction cost for the 1997 terminal are all TBC — the station's own history page does not give any of them, and this page does not guess. Those figures, together with any post-2008 terminal or runway work, remain TBC pending a further primary fetch. This research also did not locate a primary page giving Kaohsiung's IATA/ICAO codes directly — the commonly cited KHH/RCKH pair circulates in secondary sources only and is not published here for that reason.

Specifications

Runway 3,150 x 60 metres^[2]

References

3 of 3 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

- 1 Flight history review [<https://www.kia.gov.tw/filearea/history.html>]

飛航回顧

PRIMARY 高雄國際航空站 (Kaohsiung International Airport Station, Civil Aeronautics Administration) accessed 2026-08-29

The station's own archive page. States the 1944 opening as 小港飛行場, the 1965-07-01 CAA takeover forming 高雄航空站, the 1969 upgrade to international-station status, the October 1972 opening of international service with China Airlines' Kaohsiung-Hong Kong route, the 1997-01-11 new international terminal, and the 2008 Kaohsiung MRT connection.

- 2 Kaohsiung International Airport facility data [<https://www.kia.gov.tw/>]

PRIMARY 高雄國際航空站 (Kaohsiung International Airport Station, Civil Aeronautics Administration) accessed 2026-08-29

States the runway as 3,150 by 60 metres.

- 3 Airport distribution map [<https://www.caa.gov.tw/Article.aspx?a=982&lang=1>]

機場分佈圖

PRIMARY 交通部民用航空局 (Civil Aeronautics Administration, MOTC) accessed 2026-08-29

CAA's own list of the 17 airports under its administration, naming Kaohsiung International Airport among them.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.